



VOLLEYBALL

1. History of Volleyball

- **The Origin (1895):** Volleyball was invented in 1895 by William G. Morgan, a physical director at the Young Men's Christian Association (YMCA) in Holyoke, Massachusetts.
- **The Purpose:** Morgan sought to create a less strenuous, low-impact alternative physical activity for older members who found basketball's physical contact ('bumping' or 'jolting') too demanding.
- **Original Name:** The sport was originally called 'Mintonette'.
- **A Hybrid Sport:** Morgan uniquely blended elements from several established sports:
 - **Basketball:** The ball concept.
 - **Tennis:** The net placement across the court.
 - **Handball:** The primary use of hands and upper body.
 - **Baseball:** The concept of innings (later evolved into sets).
- **Official Debut (1896):** Morgan introduced the sport at the YMCA Physical Director's Conference at Springfield College, Massachusetts. It was renamed 'Volleyball' due to the action of volleying the ball back and forth.
- **Standardization (1928):** As the sport rapidly gained international traction, official governing bodies were required. The USVBA (United States Volleyball Association) was formed in 1928 to standardize playing rules.

2. Basic Rules & Scoring

Team Composition & Rotation

- **Team Size:** 6 players on the court per team (3 front-row players and 3 back-row players).
- **Hits Per Side:** A team is allowed a maximum of 3 hits to return the ball over the net.
- **Consecutive Hits:** A single player cannot contact the ball twice in succession. (Note: A block at the net does not count as a team hit).
- **Position Switching:** After the serve is executed, front-row players are permitted to switch positions at the net.
- **Ghost Position Rule:** If playing informally with only 5 players, a 'ghost position' is used. When that position rotates to serve, the team automatically forfeits the serve and point.



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Scoring System (Rally Scoring)

- **Rally Scoring:** A point is awarded on every single play/rally, regardless of which team served.
- **Offensive Scoring:** The offense scores when the defense misses, hits out of bounds, or fails to return the ball.
- **Defensive Scoring:** The defense scores when the offense misses, hits out of bounds, serves into the net, or commits a fault.
- **Match Play:** Games/Sets are played to 25 points. A team must win by at least 2 points (no point cap).

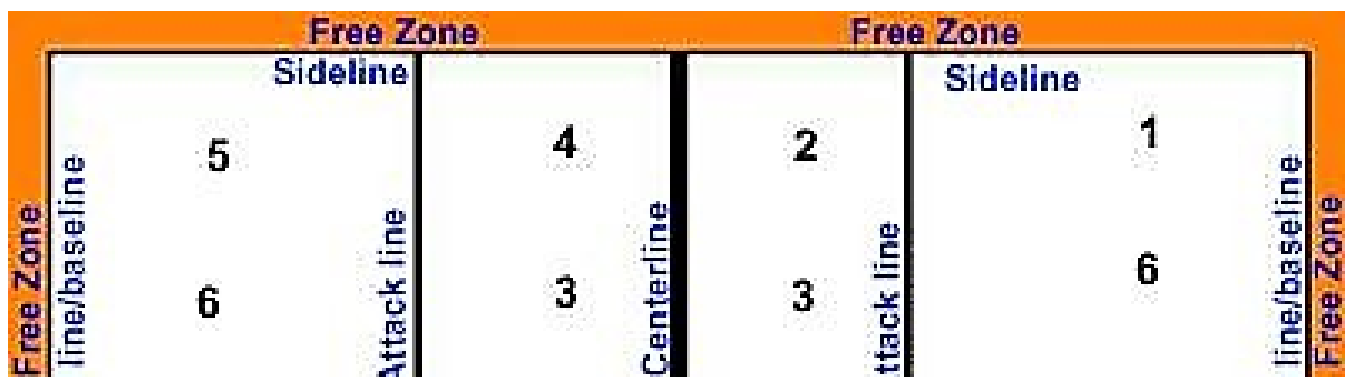
In-Bounds vs. Out-of-Bounds

- **In-Bounds:** Any ball that contacts the floor on or inside the boundary lines is IN.
- **Out-of-Bounds:** A ball is considered OUT if it touches:
 - The antennae or attached net ropes outside boundary lines.
 - The floor completely outside the court boundaries.
 - The referee stand, pole, or supporting cables.
 - The ceiling or any overhead structural apparatus.

Common Rule Violations

- **Foot Fault:** Stepping on or over the end line during service execution.
- **Net Contact:** Touching any part of the net while the ball is actively in play.
- **Illegal Contact:** Catching, carrying, palming, scooping, or throwing the ball.
- **Net Reach Fault:** Reaching fully over or stepping completely under the net into the opponent's space during play.
- **Back-Row Attack Fault:** A back-row player attacking or blocking a ball above net height while standing on or in front of the 10-foot (3-meter) attack line.
- **Illegal Service Block:** Blocking or directly spiking an opponent's serve on or inside the 3-meter line.

3. Facilities, Equipment & Sanction Cards





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Court Specifications

Court Feature / Zone	Dimensions & Placement	Description & Rules
Overall Court	60 ft × 30 ft (18 m × 9 m)	Divided into two equal 30 ft × 30 ft (9 m × 9 m) playing halves.
Center Line	Directly under the net	Divides the court equally into two halves; extends from sideline to sideline.
Attack Line (10-ft Line)	10 ft (3 m) from center line	Separates the front-row attack zone from the back-row defensive zone.
End Line / Baseline	30 ft (9 m) long at court ends	Defines the back boundaries of the court; server must stand behind this line.
Sidelines	60 ft (18 m) long along sides	Defines the lateral boundaries of the playing field.
Free Zone	Minimum 10 ft (3 m) wide around court	Unobstructed space surrounding boundary lines where players can play balls out of bounds.
Court Rotation Zones	Positions 1 to 6 on each side	FRONT ROW (ATTACKERS & PRIMARY BLOCKERS) Pos 2: Right Front (Opposite Hitter) Pos 3: Middle Front (Middle Blocker)



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		Pos 4: Left Front (Outside Hitter) BACK ROW (DEFENSIVE SPECIALISTS & SERVE RECEIVE) Pos 1: Right Back (Setter/Opposite Hitter) Pos 6: Middle Back (Libero) Pos 5: Left Back (Outside Hitter)
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Equipment Overview

- **Net & Poles:** Official nets measure 32 ft long by 39 inches tall. Men's height is 8 ft 0 in (2.43 m); Women's height is 7 ft 4 in (2.24 m). Poles measure 10.5 to 16 ft high, made of steel/aluminum.
- **Volleyballs:** Indoor balls are smooth leather molded to a bladder; outdoor/beach balls are stitched composite material resistant to water and weather.
- **Footwear & Apparel:** Gum-rubber soles provide optimal traction for lateral shifts. Players wear comfortable jersey tops with clear numbers (front/back) and shorts/spandex.
- **Protective Gear:** Knee pads are critical for floor impact protection during slides and digs. Elbow pads and arm sleeves are also common.

Official Sanction Cards

- **Yellow Card (■):** Issued as a formal warning for minor misconduct (no point penalty awarded).
- **Red Card (■):** Issued for severe or repeated misconduct. Results in a penalty point and loss of service to the opponent.
- **Yellow + Red Card (Joint):** Referees holding both cards simultaneously signifies automatic ejection/dismissal of the player for the remainder of the set/match.



4. The 6 Core Skills of Volleyball

- **Serving:** The action that initiates play. Can be executed underhand or overhand (floater, topspin, or jump serve). A well-placed serve puts the opposing team at an immediate tactical disadvantage.
- **Passing (Bumping):** The primary contact after a serve or hit crosses the net. Uses connected forearms to form a flat 'platform' to absorb force and control the ball high toward the setter.
- **Setting:** The second hit of a rally, typically executed overhead using fingertips. The setter directs the ball accurately to position an attacker for an offensive spike.
- **Hitting / Spiking:** An aggressive, mid-air overhead strike delivered forcefully over the net into the opponent's court. Timing, jump height, and ball placement are crucial.
- **Digging:** A specialized defensive technique used to intercept low, fast-driven attacks or spikes near the floor to keep the play active.
- **Blocking:** A net-defense tactic where front-row players jump vertically at the net with arms extended upward, forming a defensive wall to deflect or redirect incoming attacks.

5. Specialized Player Roles

Front Row (At the Net)

Position 4: LEFT FRONT — OUTSIDE HITTER

- **Main Job:** Main left-side attacker and blocker.
- **Offense:** Hits balls set to the left antenna. They get the most sets when the team gets an awkward or hard pass.
- **Defense:** Blocks the opponent's right-side hitter.

Position 3: MIDDLE FRONT — MIDDLE BLOCKER

- **Main Job:** Main net blocker and quick hitter.
- **Offense:** Hits quick, low sets right above the setter in the center.
- **Defense:** Leads the net blocking. Moves left or right to help the other front-row players form a double block.

Position 2: RIGHT FRONT — OPPOSITE HITTER / SETTER

- **Main Job:** Right-side attacker and blocker.



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- **Offense:** Hits balls from the right side. (If the team sets from the front row, the Setter plays here).
- **Defense:** Blocks the opponent's main left-side hitter.

Back Row (Defense & Passing)

Position 1: RIGHT BACK — SETTER / OPPOSITE HITTER

- **Main Job:** Serving, running up to set, and right-back defense.
- **Serving:** Serves the ball to start each play.
- **Setting:** If the Setter is in Pos 1, they run up to the net right after the serve to set the ball for the attackers.
- **Defense:** Digs straight shots coming down the sideline from the opponent's left-side hitter.

Position 6: MIDDLE BACK — LIBERO / DEFENSIVE SPECIALIST

- **Main Job:** Main passer and deep defense anchor.
- **Passing:** Passes incoming serves to the setter.
- **Defense:** Digs deep hits and tips in the middle of the court. Passes the second ball if the setter makes the first dig.

Position 5: LEFT BACK — OUTSIDE HITTER / DEFENSIVE SPECIALIST

- **Main Job:** Passing serves and digging diagonal spikes.
- **Passing & Defense:** Passes serves on the left side and digs hard cross-court spikes.
- **Back-Row Attack:** Can jump from behind the 3-meter line to hit back-row sets.